

Al-Ajrumiyyah

The Ajurrumian Introduction to the Science of Grammar

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Chapter 1 : Al-Kalam

1.1 Kalam

The Basmala

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

بِسْمِ

in the name of

اللَّهُ

Allah

الرَّحْمَنِ

the Most Merciful; general mercy encompassing all creation

الرَّحِيمِ

the Most Compassionate; mercy specific to the believers

In the name of Allah, the Most Merciful, the Most Compassionate.

Sidi Shaykh Abdullahi begins every session with the Basmala because knowledge is sacred and not merely technical. The manner in which you enter study shapes what you receive from it. A narration states that every important matter not begun with the Basmala is cut off.

Sidi Shaykh Abdullahi explains that the legal status of the Basmala varies with context:

- Obligatory in prayer at the opening of Surat al-Fatiha
- Recommended before eating and before study
- Permissible before a neutral act
- Disliked in the bathroom
- Forbidden before a sinful act

Grammatically, as explained by Sidi Shaykh Abdullahi, the Basmala is a prepositional phrase. The particle بِ attaches to سَمِ and requires a point of attachment (ta'alluq), i.e, a verb or verbal idea, stated or implied. Before eating the implied verb is "I eat." The verb is omitted for a reason of eloquence (balagha): leaving it unspecified makes the formula suitable for every action. Scholars differ on the meaning of بِ here. The majority hold it expresses seeking help (isti'ana). Others, including al-Zamakhshari, read it as accompaniment (musahaba) or involvement (mulabasa). All readings are grammatically valid.

Types of Speech

ملاكلا وه ظفلاا ب كرملا ليفةلا ع ضولاا

ملاكلا

speech; the technical term for a grammatically complete utterance

ظفلاا

utterance; any sound formed from the letters of Arabic

ب كرملا

composed; consisting of at least two words

ليفةلا

meaningful; giving the listener a complete, satisfying idea

ع ضولاا

according to established usage; belonging to actual Arabic and spoken with intent

Speech is a composed, meaningful utterance according to established usage.

The definition has four conditions, each of which rules something out.

The first, utterance (lafz), rules out gestures and signs in the primary technical sense. Scholars note that Prophet Zakariyya, peace be upon him, communicated by sign and the Quran counts it as speech in a broader linguistic sense, but technically lafz requires sound formed from the Arabic letters.

The second, composed (murakkab), rules out single words: لدمحم alone is not speech in the technical sense.

The third, meaningful (mufid) rules out incomplete constructions. لدمحمي فدمجسما is mufid because the listener receives a complete idea. لدمحم يذلا is not, because the listener waits for more.

Lastly, according to established usage (bil-wad') rules out two things: words spoken without intent such as speech in sleep or madness where intent is absent, and invented or nonsense sounds that do not belong to established Arabic.

1.2 Word Types (Ism, Fi'l, Harf)

ه ماسقاؤ: ثة ثلاث، م سا، ل عفو فرحو عاجي نعملا

ماسقاؤ

divisions; plural of ماسة

م سا

noun; a word with meaning in itself, not bound to a time

ل عفو

verb; a word with meaning in itself, bound to a time

فہرہ

particle; a word with meaning only in relation to others

عاجی، نعمہ

that carries a meaning; distinguishing meaningful particles from mere letters

Its divisions are three: noun, verb, and particle that carries a meaning.

Every word in Arabic is one of three things: a noun, a verb, or a particle. This division was arrived at by methodical study (*istiqrāʾ*) of the entire Arabic corpus and has no valid exception in classical usage.

A noun is a word with meaning in itself, not bound to a time. Examples: **بائتک**, **دمحم**.

A verb is a word with meaning in itself, bound to a time. Examples: كتبه (he wrote), يكتبه (he writes).

A particle is a word with meaning only in relation to others. Examples: **فِي** (in), **مِنْ** (from).

1.3 Signs of the Ism

من م، می، لاء، من عو، می، لعو، می، فو، ب، برو، ع، اب، لاء، ف، لک، لاء، م، لاء، لاء، ف، و، ر، حو، م، س، ق، لاء، ی، هو، و، ا، و، لاء، ع، اب، لاء، و، ع، ا، لاء، و، م، س، لاء، ف، ر، ع، ی، ض، ف، خ، لاء، ب، من، ی، و، ن، ت، لاء، ل، و، خ، د، و، ف، ل، ا، م، لاء، لاء، و، م، ی، لاء، ف، و، ر، حو، ض، ف، خ، لاء، ی، هو

ض ف خدا

the genitive case; also called jarr; indicated by kasra or its substitute at the end of the noun

من یونٹا

nunation; the doubled ending sound appearing as *on* on indefinite nouns

فالأأملاو

the definite article al; attaches only to nouns

فور حض فخر

the prepositions; particles that govern the genitive case

فورح مسقلا

the letters of oath; a subset of the letters that attach only to nouns in oaths

The noun is identified by the genitive case, nunation, the entry of the definite article upon it, and the prepositions, which are: from, to, away from, upon, in, perhaps, the ba, the kaf, and the lam, and the letters of oath, which are the waw, the ba, and the ta.

The noun is identified by accepting any one of four things: the genitive case, nunation, the definite article, or the prepositions upon it.

The genitive case (khafd) means the noun can take a kasra or its substitute at its end when governed by a preposition or by another noun in annexation (idafa). The ability to take this case marker is exclusive to nouns.

Nunation (tanwin) is the doubled ending sound that appears on indefinite nouns. It takes three forms depending on the case of the noun: dammattan in the nominative (rafa), fathatan in the accusative (nasb), and kasratan in the genitive (khafd). Its presence on a word confirms that word is a noun.

The definite article **الـ** attaches only to nouns and is therefore a positive identifier. When **الـ** enters upon a word, that word is a noun.

The prepositions (huruf al-khafd) govern only nouns and so their presence identifies the word that follows them as a noun. Ibn Ajurrum lists nine: **من** (from), **إلى** (to), **من** (away from), **على** (upon), **في** (in), **رب** (perhaps), **بـ** (the ba), **كـ** (the kaf), and **لـ** (the lam).

Also included are the letters of oath (huruf al-qasam): **و** (the waw), **بـ** (the ba), and **تـ** (the ta). These are included here because they can only attach to nouns, making them additional identifiers of the noun even though they are not prepositions in the primary sense.

The commentary illustrates each sign with its own examples.

Example 1

تَرَرَم رَكِبَ

Solution

"I passed by Bakr." **رَكِبَ** carries a kasra at its end, governed by the preposition **بـ**. The presence of khafd confirms it is a noun.

Example 2

أَسْمَحَم ، بَاتَكَ تَأْمَلَسَم

Solution

Each of these carries tanwin. Its presence alone, regardless of case, is enough to confirm each word is a noun.

Example 3

أَلْ جَرَا ، بَاتَكَا تَسْرَلَمَا

Solution

Each carries the definite article **الـ** at the start. Since **الـ** attaches only to nouns, its presence identifies each word as a noun.

Example 4

تَبْهَذُ نَم تَبِيلَا إِلَى تَسْرَلَمَا

Solution

"I went from the house to the school." **تَبِيلَا** and **تَسْرَلَمَا** are both nouns, identified twice over here: by the prepositions **من** and **إلى** entering upon them, and by carrying the definite article **الـ**.

Example 5

الله وندهتجلا

Solution

"By Allah, I will surely strive." الله is identified as a noun here by the waw of oath, و , which attaches only to an explicit noun, never to a pronoun.

1.4 Signs of the Fi'l

فرعي، مدقب، نيسلاو، فوسو، عاتو، ثينأتلا، مة، كاسلا، فرحلاو، ام لا، حاصيه، معم، لياد، م، سلا، لاو، لياد، ل، عفا، ل، عفاو

مدق the particle qad; attaches only to verbs; with the past tense it means "indeed" or confirms the action occurred; with the present tense it expresses expectation or possibility

نيسلا

the sin; a single letter prefix indicating the near future, e.g. بتكيس (he will write, soon)

فوس

sawfa; a separate word indicating the more distant future, e.g. فوس بتكيس (he will write, eventually)

عاتو، ثينأتلا، مة، كاسلا

the silent feminine ta; the sukun-bearing ta that attaches to the end of a past tense verb to mark a feminine subject, e.g. تبتك (she wrote); called silent because it carries a sukun, not a vowel

لياد

sign; identifier; the marker that confirms a word belongs to a given category

حاصيه

is compatible; fits; is appropriate for

The verb is identified by qad, the sin, sawfa, and the silent feminine ta. The particle is that with which neither the sign of the noun nor the sign of the verb is compatible.

The verb is identified by accepting any of four markers. None of these can attach to a noun or a particle, so their presence on a word confirms it is a verb.

Qad (مدق) is a particle that attaches only to verbs. With a past tense verb it conveys confirmation, بتك means "he has indeed written." With a present tense verb it conveys expectation or possibility, مدق بتكيس means he may write. Because qad can only attach to verbs it serves as a clear identifier.

The sin (س) and sawfa (فوس) are both future markers and attach only to present tense verbs. The sin indicates the near future and sawfa the more distant future. Both are exclusive to verbs and so confirm a word's verbal identity when present.

The silent feminine ta (عاتو، ثينأتلا، مة، كاسلا) attaches to the end of past tense verbs to indicate a feminine subject. It is called silent because it carries a sukun rather than a vowel, تبتك (she wrote). This ta is distinct

from the ta of the second person masculine, تبتك (you wrote) which carries a fatha and is not a sign of the verb in this sense.

The particle has no positive signs of its own. It is identified purely by exclusion: if a word accepts neither the signs of the noun nor the signs of the verb, it is a particle. Ibn Ajurrum does not list signs for the particle because there are none to list. The particle is what remains after the noun and verb have been accounted for.

The commentary shows qad carrying two different meanings depending on which tense it attaches to.

Example 6

قد حلفاً نؤمنوا

Solution

”The believers have certainly succeeded” (al-Mu’minun 23:1). قد enters on the past tense verb حلفاً, conveying confirmation that the action has definitely occurred.

Example 7

قد قلدصير بونكلا

Solution

”The liar sometimes tells the truth.” Here قد enters on the present tense verb قلدصير, and instead conveys that the action happens only rarely.

Example 8

لوقيس عاهفسلا نم سائلا

Solution

”The foolish among the people will say” (al-Baqarah 2:142). The sin prefix on لوقيس marks the near future and attaches only to a present tense verb.

Example 9

فوسلوك يطعرك برى ضرته

Solution

”And your Lord is going to give you, and you will be satisfied” (al-Duha 93:5). فوس marks the more distant future, again attaching only to a present tense verb.

Example 10

تلاقة شئاء م أنين مؤملا

Solution

”Aisha, Mother of the Believers, said.” The silent ta at the end of تلاقة marks the subject as feminine. It attaches only to the past tense.

Chapter 2 : Al-I'rab

2.1 I'rab: Definition and the Word Categories

Introduction to the Eight Word Categories

Before the signs of each case are detailed, Sidi Shaykh Abdullahi says it helps to know the eight word categories that have their own dedicated signs. These are the categories that behave differently from the basic singular noun, and they come up repeatedly in everything that follows.

Show the Eight Word Categories

The singular noun (ism mufrad) is any noun that refers to one thing and is not dual, plural, or one of the Five Nouns.

Example: مديز باماك

The broken plural (jamu taksir) is a plural formed by altering the internal structure of the word rather than adding an ending.

Example: لاجر (men), باماك (books)

The sound feminine plural (jamu muannath salim) is a plural formed by adding تاه to a noun.

Example: تاملمست اولمست

The sound masculine plural (jamu mudhakkar salim) is a plural formed by adding نو in the nominative (rafa) or نيه in the accusative (nasb) and genitive (khafd).

Example: نوملمست نيملمست

The dual (muthanna) is formed by adding نل in the nominative (rafa) or نيه in the accusative (nasb) and genitive (khafd).

Example: نلاجر ناباماك

The Five Nouns (al-asma al-khamsa) are: لكوأ (your father), لكوأ (your brother), لكوأ (your father-in-law), لكوأ (your mouth), and وذللم (one possessing wealth). They take letters rather than vowels as their case signs and must be in annexation (idafa) to do so.

The Five Verbs (al-afal al-khamsa) are present tense verbs with a dual, plural, or feminine second-person pronoun attached.

Example: نلاعفد، نلاعفد، نلاعفد، نلاعفد، نلاعفد

Their case is marked by the presence or absence of the nun rather than by a vowel.

The present tense verb with nothing attached (fil mudari lam yattasil bi-akhirihi shay) is a verb in its base form with no pronoun suffix.

Example: ب ت ك ي ب ه ذ ي

It takes the standard vowel signs for rafa and nasb and drops the nun for jazm only when it is one of the Five Verbs.

Bab al-I'rab

مع فرلا ، ب ص ن لا و ، مض ف خ لا و لا و مض ف خ ما ه ي ف
ل ما و ع ل ا ق ل ا خ ل ا د ل ا ما ه ي ا ع ا ظ ف ا و ا . ا ر ي د ق ت ه م ا س ق ا و : ت ع ب ر ا ، مع فر ، ب ص ن و ، مض ف خ و ، مز ج و ا م س ا ل ا ف ن م ك ا ذ
ب ا ر ع ل ا و ه ر ي ب ع ت ر خ ا و ا م ل ك ل ا ف ل ا ت خ ل ا

ب ا ر ع ل ا

i'rab; the technical term for the change that occurs at the ends of words due to governing factors

ر ي ب ع ت

change; alteration

ر خ ا و ا

ends; the final letters of words; singular ر خ آ

م ل ك ل ا

words; plural of م ل ك

ل ما و ع ل ا

governing factors; the elements that cause case changes; singular ل م ا ع

ا ظ ف ا

pronounced; audibly present

ا ر ي د ق ت

estimated; implied but not audibly present

ع فر

rafa; the nominative case

ب ص ن

nasb; the accusative case

م ض ف خ

khafd; the genitive case

م ز ج

jazm; the jussive case, exclusive to verbs

I'rab is the change that occurs at the ends of words due to the different governing factors that enter upon them, whether that change is pronounced or only estimated. Its divisions are four: rafa, nasb, khafd, and jazm. Nouns take from these rafa, nasb, and khafd, and there is no jazm for them. Verbs take from these rafa, nasb, and jazm, and there is no khafd for them.

Sidi Shaykh Abdullahi defines i'rab as the change that occurs at the ends of words due to the different governing factors (awamil) that enter upon them, whether that change is pronounced or only estimated. Its four states are rafa (nominative), nasb (accusative), khafd or jarr (genitive), and jazm (jussive). Nouns take the first three. Verbs take the first, second, and fourth. Nouns do not take jazm; verbs do not take khafd.

The commentary's own illustration of this is worth walking through slowly, since it shows the whole point of i'rab in a single name carried across three sentences.

Example 1

رضي الله عنه

Solution

"Muhammad arrived." رضي الله عنه is marfu', since it is the fa'il of رضي الله عنه, a governing factor that requires raf'.

Example 2

تبارك وتعالى

Solution

"I saw Muhammad." The same name now ends in nasb, because the governing factor changed to تبارك وتعالى, which requires its object to be mansub.

Example 3

تفضل الله به

Solution

"I was fortunate to have Muhammad." The name now ends in khafd, because the preposition ب requires the noun after it to be majrur. Notice that the final letter of the name itself never changes, only its case, which is exactly what i'rab means.

The commentary then shows the same logic applied to a verb.

Example 4

رفسني

Solution

"Ibrahim travels." رفسني is marfu', since no governing factor requiring nasb or jazm has entered upon it.

Example 5

ن ل ر فاسي م يهاري

Solution

"Ibrahim will not travel." The verb is now mansub, since ن ل is a governing factor that requires nasb.

Example 6

م ل ر فاسي م يهاري

Solution

"Ibrahim did not travel." The verb is now majzum, since م ل is a governing factor that requires jazm.

Finally, the commentary distinguishes a change that is pronounced (lafzi) from one that is only estimated (taqdiri), which is why the matn's definition includes "whether pronounced or estimated" in the first place.

Example 7

وعدي يتفلا ي ضاقلأوي ملاغو

Solution

"The young man, the judge, and my servant call out." All three nouns here are marfu' as fa'il, but none of them can physically carry a visible damma, since one ends in alif maqsura, one in ya, and one in a possessive ya. The raf' is present, but only estimated, not pronounced, unlike the damma on the dal of دمحوم in the first example above.

2.2 Signs of Rafa

ةملاع فرلاي فل عفا ،ع راضما اذ ل صتا به ريمض ،ةقينة وأ ريمض ،ع مج وأ ريمض ةتثوما .ةبطاخما ،كومحو ،كوفو وذو .لامامأو ،ف الأ نوكتة ملاع فرلاي فةقينة عامسلأ .مةصاخامأو ،نونا نوكتة ملاع فرلاي ف:ن يعصومي فع مج ركذما ،م للسا ي فو عامسلأ ،ةسمخلا ني هو ،كوبأ ،كوخأ ،درفما ع مجو ،ريسكتا ع مجو ثنوما ،م للسا ل عفا وع راضما ي ذلا م ل لصتيه رخآ .عي شامأو ،اولا :تاملاع ،ةمضلا واولا ،ف الأ .نونا واما ف ،ةمضلا نوكتة ملاع فرلاي فةعبرأ :نع ضاومي فم سلا ع فرلا ع برأ

ةمضلا

the damma; the primary sign of rafa; the short vowel u at the end of a word

اولا

the waw; the letter و used as a case sign in the sound masculine plural and the Five Nouns

فالأ

the alif; the letter ا used as a case sign in the dual

نون

the nun; the letter ن whose presence marks rafa in the Five Verbs

م سلا درفملا

the singular noun; any noun referring to one thing, not dual or plural

معجم ريسكتلا

the broken plural; a plural formed by altering the internal structure of the word

معجم ث نؤملا م لسللا

the sound feminine plural; a plural formed by adding تـ

ل عفلا ع راضملا

the present tense verb

معجم ركنملا م لسللا

the sound masculine plural; a plural formed by adding نـ or نو-

عامسلا أ تسمخلا

the Five Nouns: ،كوبأ ،كوخأ ،كومح ،كوف وذ لام

تينتة

the dual; the form indicating two of something

Rafa has four signs: the damma, the waw, the alif, and the nun. The damma is a sign of rafa in four places: the singular noun, the broken plural, the sound feminine plural, and the present tense verb that has nothing attached to its end. The waw is a sign of rafa in two places: the sound masculine plural, and the Five Nouns, which are: your father, your brother, your father-in-law, your mouth, and one possessing wealth. The alif is a sign of rafa in the dual noun exclusively. The nun is a sign of rafa in the present tense verb when a dual pronoun, a plural pronoun, or the feminine second-person pronoun is attached to it.

Of the four signs, the *damma* carries the most weight, since it governs the widest range of forms: the singular noun, the broken plural, the sound feminine plural, and the present tense verb with nothing attached to its end. It need not always be pronounced. Where pronunciation is simply impossible, as with a noun ending in *alif* like *ي سوم*, or where it would be phonologically awkward, as with a noun ending in *ya* like *بي ضاقللا*, the *damma* is understood rather than heard. Grammarians call this estimation (*taqdir*), distinguishing it from the ordinary, audible case (*zahira*).

The *waw* takes over in exactly two places: the sound masculine plural, as in *نوملسم*, and the Five Nouns, *،كوبأ ،كوخأ ،كومح ،كوف وذ لام*, though only once they stand in annexation (*idafa*). Outside of annexation the Five Nouns lose this special treatment and simply decline like any other noun.

The *alif*, by contrast, marks only the dual, *،نلاجر نادمحم*, and nothing else.

With verbs the logic shifts: it is the *nun*'s presence, not its shape, that signals *rafa* in the Five Verbs, *نيلعفة ،نلاعفة ،نلاعفة ،نولعفة ،نولعفة*. Once these verbs move into the accusative or jussive, the *nun* simply falls away, so it is often easier to remember the rule as an absence rather than a presence: no *nun*, no *rafa*.

2.3 Signs of Nasb

• عي شامأو ،ف الأ نوكتفة ملاء بصلالي فءامسلأ ،ةسمخلا :نوحزت يار كإبأ كإخأو امو بهبشأ .مك اذ
ةثلاث :نع ضاومي فءمسلأ ،درفملا معمجو ،ريسكتلا بل عفلاو عراضملا اذإ بل خد هلاء ب صانم لو بل صتيه مرخاب
س مخ :ت امللاء ،ةحتفلا ،ف الأو ،قرسكلاو ،ءايلاو فذحو .نونلا ا مأف ،ةحتفلا نوكتفة ملاء بصلالي ف
بصلالو

ةحتفلا

the fatha; the primary sign of nasb; the short vowel a at the end of a word

قرسكلا

the kasra; the short vowel i; used as the sign of nasb for the sound feminine plural

ءايلا

the ya; the letter ي used as the sign of nasb for the dual and sound masculine plural

فذحو نونلا

dropping the nun; the removal of the nun as the sign of nasb and jazm for the Five Verbs

ب صان

a nasb particle; a particle that governs the accusative case in a following verb

Nasb has five signs: the fatha, the alif, the kasra, the ya, and dropping the nun. The fatha is a sign of nasb in three places: the singular noun, the broken plural, and the present tense verb when a nasb particle enters upon it and nothing is attached to its end. The alif is a sign of nasb for the Five Nouns, such as: I saw your father and your brother and whatever resembles that.

Nasb, the accusative case, marks direct objects among other roles, and covers five distinct signs rather than the four *rafa* has: one root sign, the *fatha*, and four subsidiary ones that substitute for it in particular categories.

Fatha does most of the work, appearing on the singular noun, the broken plural, and the present tense verb once a *nasb* particle enters and nothing else is attached to its end. On the singular noun it is usually explicit, but becomes implicit whenever the noun ends in *alif maqsura*, since that letter cannot physically carry a visible vowel. Let's take a look at some examples.

Example 1

تيفلا لاء

Solution

"I met Ali." تيفلا لاء is a singular noun, mansub as the object of تيفلا . Its sign is a visible fatha.

Example 2

تَقِلا يَتَفَلَا

Solution

"I met the young man." تَقِلا is a singular noun, mansub as the object of يَتَفَلَا . Its sign is an implicit fatha, since a word ending in *alif maqsura* cannot physically carry a visible vowel.

The broken plural follows the same pattern.

Example 3

تَبَحَا لَاجِرًا

Solution

"I accompanied the men." لَاجِرًا is a broken plural, mansub as the object of تَبَحَا . Its sign is a visible fatha.

The Quran supplies two clean examples of the implicit case for a broken plural.

Example 4

يَرَوْنَ سَائِلًا يَرَاكُمُ

Solution

"And you will see the people intoxicated" (al-Hajj 22:2). يَرَاكُمُ is a broken plural, mansub as the second object of يَرَوْنَ . Its sign is an implicit fatha on the alif maqsura.

Example 5

أَوْحِكُنَّ أَوْيَ مَايَلَا أَمْ كُنَّ

Solution

"And marry the unmarried among you" (al-Nur 24:32). أَوْيَ مَايَلَا is a broken plural, mansub as the object of أَوْحِكُنَّ . As with يَرَاكُمُ above, the fatha is implicit because the word ends in alif maqsura.

On the present tense verb, the same explicit/implicit split applies.

Example 6

نَلْحَرِيذُهُ يَدْعُو نِيْفَكَ

Solution

"We will never cease being devoted to it" (Taha 20:91). نَلْحَرِيذُهُ is a present tense verb, made mansub by the particle نَلْ . Since nothing is attached to its end, its sign is a visible fatha.

Example 7

يُنِضِرُ نَأْيَ عَسَةِ إِلَى الْجَمَلِ

Solution

"It pleases me that you strive toward glory." نَأْيَ is a present tense verb, made mansub by نَأْيَ . Its sign is an implicit fatha, since it ends in alif maqsura.

If the verb has the *alif* of duality, the *waw* of a masculine plural subject, or the *ya* of feminine address attached to its end, *fatha* cannot appear at all, and the sign shifts to dropping the *nun* instead: يَبْرُضُ نَأْيَ، اوْبْرُضْ نَأْيَ. If instead a confirming *nun* (heavy or light) is attached, the verb becomes fixed on *fatha* regardless of its case, نَأْيَ يَهْدِي اللَّهُ نَأْيَ، نَأْيَ يَهْدِي اللَّهُ نَأْيَ; and if the *nun* of the feminine plural is attached, it becomes fixed on *sukun* instead, نَأْيَ كَرَدَتْ لَجَمَلًا لَأْيَ.

The Five Nouns simply swap letters depending on the case: *waw* for *rafa*, *alif* for *nasb*. كَأْبَاتُ يَأْرُ كَأْخَا، كَأْبَاتُ يَأْرُ follow the same annexation requirement noted in the previous section.

The sound feminine plural breaks the pattern slightly, taking *kasra* instead of the *fatha* you would otherwise expect, purely for ease of pronunciation: كَأْبَاتُ يَأْرُ تَأْمَلُ سَمَلًا تَأْمَلُ سَمَلًا تَأْمَلُ سَمَلًا.

Ya covers two forms at once, the dual and the sound masculine plural, both of which used *alif* or *waw* for *rafa* and now converge on the same letter for *nasb* and *khafd* alike: تَأْمَلُ سَمَلًا، تَأْمَلُ سَمَلًا، تَأْمَلُ سَمَلًا.

And as with *rafa*, the Five Verbs are marked by what disappears rather than what appears: the *nun* drops for *nasb* exactly as it does for *jazm*, تَأْمَلُ سَمَلًا، تَأْمَلُ سَمَلًا، تَأْمَلُ سَمَلًا، so the nominative is the only state in which these verbs keep it.

The examples above and the commentary structure follow al-Tuhfat al-Saniyyah bi Sharh al-Muqaddimat al-Ajrumiyyah, by Muhammad Muhi al-Din 'Abd al-Hamid, translated into English here directly from the Arabic rather than from any existing published translation.

Show Practice Suggestion

For drilling these signs, Sidi Shaykh Abdullahi suggested the classical exercise book portion of al-Tuhfa al-Saniyya and Quranic parsing (i'rab al-Quran) as the two most effective tools. Working the case endings out on a real ayah, rather than an invented sentence, forces you to actually apply the rule above rather than just recognize it.

The questions on the Practice Problems page for this section are translated directly from al-Tuhfat al-Saniyyah's own review questions for this section, not from any published English translation.